



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

MOVIEGOERS at the AMC Century City theater head to a “Lilo & Stitch” screening with plenty of snacks.

A good sign for summer movies

‘Lilo & Stitch’ and a new ‘Mission: Impossible’ power a record Memorial Day weekend box office, boosting hope for theaters

BY SAMANTHA MASUNAGA

A chaotic blue alien and the high-flying escapades of Tom Cruise propelled the Memorial Day weekend box office to record heights, giving relief to theater owners still struggling from a post-pandemic malaise among moviegoers.

Walt Disney Co.’s live-action film “Lilo & Stitch” hauled in \$183 million in its opening weekend in the U.S. and Canada, according to studio estimates, landing it in first place. It’s the biggest Memorial Day weekend opener ever, not adjusting for inflation, topping “Top Gun: Maverick,” which debuted with

\$160.5 million in 2022. Paramount Pictures and Skydance Media’s “Mission: Impossible — The Final Reckoning” brought in \$77 million domestically for second place. “Final Destination Bloodlines,” “Thunderbolts*” and “Sinners” rounded out the top five this weekend. The two new studio

blockbusters were big overseas too. Globally, “Lilo & Stitch” collected \$341.7 million including domestic ticket sales. The worldwide tally for “Mission: Impossible,” the eighth in the series, was \$190 million. “This is just an extraordinary accomplishment after so many people were willing

Clinic makes house calls for migrants afraid to leave home

Patients are skipping doctor visits for fear of immigration raids. So L.A.-area provider is going to them.

BY MELISSA GOMEZ

Across Los Angeles, the Inland Empire and the Coachella Valley, one community health center is extending its services to immigrant patients in their homes after realizing that people were skipping critical medical appointments because they’ve become too afraid to venture out. St. John’s Community Health, one of the largest nonprofit community healthcare providers in Los Angeles County that caters to low-income and working-class residents, launched a

home visitation program in March after learning that patients were missing routine and urgent care appointments because they feared being taken in by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents. St. John’s, which offers services through a network of clinics and mobile units across the region, estimates that at least 25,000 of its patients are undocumented, and about a third of them suffer from chronic conditions, including diabetes and hypertension, which require routine checkups. But these patients were missing tests to monitor their blood sugar and blood pressure, as well as appointments to pick up prescription refills. Earlier this year, the health center began surveying patients and found that hundreds were canceling appointments “solely due to

[See Immigrants, A6]

Villaraigosa pivots toward oil industry

Former L.A. mayor’s environmentalist credentials are questioned as he runs for governor.

BY SEEMA MEHTA AND LAURA J. NELSON

As California positions itself as a leader on climate change, former Los Angeles mayor and gubernatorial candidate Antonio Villaraigosa is pivoting away from his own track record as an environmental champion to defend the state’s struggling oil industry. Villaraigosa’s work to expand mass transit, plant trees and reduce carbon emissions made him a favorite of the environmental movement, but the former state Assembly speaker also

accepted more than \$1 million in campaign contributions and other financial support from oil companies and other donors tied to the industry over more than three decades in public life, according to city and state fundraising disclosures reviewed by The Times. Since entering the race last year to replace Gov. Gavin Newsom, Villaraigosa has accepted more than \$176,000 from donors with ties to the oil industry, including from a company that operates oil fields in the San Joaquin Valley and Los Angeles County, the disclosures show. The clash between Villaraigosa’s environmentalist credentials and oil-industry ties surfaced in the governor’s race after Valero announced in late April that its Bay Area refinery would close next year, not long af

[See Villaraigosa, A7]

Fearing spies, Taiwan deports Chinese

Authorities demand hard-to-source papers from mainland-born residents. Some are kicked off the island.

BY STEPHANIE YANG AND XIN-YUN WU

TAIPEI, Taiwan — Liu Jia-yen had been living in Taiwan for more than two decades when she received notice that she was at risk of being deported. In April, the National Immigration Agency told Liu, a 51-year-old Chinese immigrant, she had three months to provide evidence that she



I-HWA CHENG AFP/Getty Images

A TAIWANESE flag glows in the sunlight at the Chiang Kai-shek Memorial Hall in Taipei last year.

gave up her household registration — an official record of residence that grants benefits such as healthcare and education — in Guangxi, China. If she couldn’t find the right documents, she’d have to leave. Liu thought she’d submitted the files long ago and called her 26-year-old daughter, Ariel Ko, in tears. Ko, who was born and raised in Taiwan, called the immigration agency dozens of times over the next few days, unable to reach an operator. Meanwhile in China, Liu’s 80-year-old grandfather began visiting his local police station in search of old records, and her brother scoured his list of govern

[See Taiwan, A4]

COLUMN ONE

L.A. prop maker finds new life preserving beloved pets

Famous as the taxidermist to film sets and stars for over 100 years, Bischoff’s is now the go-to for grieving owners.

BY JESSIE SCHIEWE

In a room inside a North Hollywood warehouse, dozens of pets are ready for their owners to take them home. Boots, a young black-and-white domestic shorthair cat, lies on his back, pawing playfully at the air. A trio of red, yellow and green parrots and cockatiels sit on wooden perches, oblivious to the piercing stare of a blue-eyed feline a few feet away. Princess, a senior Chihuahua, rests with her eyes closed and body curled into a tight cocoon, as a frenetic hamster named Ponby stands upright, his eyes bulging. There’s a hairless guinea pig, a giant red macaw and an adorably chunky pit bull named Messy. All of these animals are loose, liberated from the confines of cages and leashes, and yet no havoc has ensued. These animals are also all dead. It’s an everyday scene at Bischoff’s the Animal Kingdom, a Los Angeles taxidermy business that has been preserving animals for 103 years. The business is multifold — Bischoff’s creates and rents out prop animals to

[See Pets, A12]



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

CO-OWNERS Ace Alexander, left, and Rey Macias at Bischoff’s the Animal Kingdom.

Billionaire turns to fossil fuels

Phil Anschutz is now touting a gas plant instead of a wind farm, Sammy Roth writes. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

Woes over AI ‘hallucinations’

Using artificial intelligence is costly for lawyers in lost cases and more, Michael Hiltzik writes. **BUSINESS, A9**

At Cannes, bold works stand out

Spike Lee was among the filmmakers taking big swings at the contentious festival. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather

Partly sunny.

L.A. Basin: 74/59. **B5**

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